

## UNIT 10 / Work, messages and your final mission

# Can, must and would like

Your goal: Use common modal verbs with an infinitive at the end.

## 01 Learn the idea

Modal verbs add ideas such as ability, necessity or a wish. Ich kann schwimmen means I can swim; ich muss arbeiten means I must work; ich möchte lernen means I would like to learn. The modal is conjugated near the start, while the other verb stays in its infinitive form at the end.

Useful forms are ich kann/du kannst, ich muss/du musst and ich möchte/du möchtest. Add other information between the two verbs: Ich muss heute arbeiten. Do not conjugate both verbs. Practise by finding the modal and the infinitive in each sentence and drawing a line between them.

## Words and phrases

| German                     | English                       |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Ich kann schwimmen.        | I can swim.                   |
| Ich muss heute arbeiten.   | I have to work today.         |
| Ich möchte Deutsch lernen. | I would like to learn German. |
| Kannst du kommen?          | Can you come?                 |
| Du musst warten.           | You have to wait.             |

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

## 02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

**Mia**

Kannst du heute kommen?

Can you come today?

**Ben**

Nein, ich muss arbeiten. Morgen kann ich kommen.

No, I have to work. Tomorrow I can come.

**Mia**

Gut, dann bis morgen!

Good, then see you tomorrow!

### Your real-life mission

Write one ability, one obligation and one wish. Include a time phrase in two sentences and check that the infinitive is last.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

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## 03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

### 1. What does “Ich kann schwimmen.” mean?

- A. I have to work today.
- B. I can swim.
- C. I would like to learn German.

### 2. What does “Ich muss heute arbeiten.” mean?

- A. I would like to learn German.
- B. Can you come?
- C. I have to work today.

### 3. What does “Ich möchte Deutsch lernen.” mean?

- A. I would like to learn German.
- B. Can you come?
- C. You have to wait.

### 4. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Ich muss heute arbeiten.
- B. Ich muss heute arbeite.
- C. Ich arbeiten muss heute.

### 5. Why can Ben not come today?

- A. He is swimming
- B. He has to work
- C. He is buying a ticket

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

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## 04 Answer key and review

### 1. B - I can swim.

“Ich kann schwimmen.” means “I can swim.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

### 2. C - I have to work today.

“Ich muss heute arbeiten.” means “I have to work today.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

### 3. A - I would like to learn German.

“Ich möchte Deutsch lernen.” means “I would like to learn German.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

### 4. A - Ich muss heute arbeiten.

Muss is conjugated; arbeiten remains an infinitive at the end.

### 5. B - He has to work

Ben explains ich muss arbeiten.

### One possible mission response

Ich kann schwimmen. Heute muss ich arbeiten. Am Abend möchte ich Deutsch lernen.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

### Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

### Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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